RECALLING Article 28(b) of the Convention on the International Maritime Organization con cerning the functions of the Committee, NOTING the new regulation II-1/3-6 of the In ter national Convention for the Safety of Life at Sea (SOLAS), 1974, as amended (hereinaft e r referred to as ■the Convention■) adopted by resolution MSC.134(76), concerning access to and with in spaces in the cargo area of oil tankers and bulk carriers, NOTING ALSO th at the aforementioned regulation provides that the means of access referred to therein s hall comply with the requirements of Technical provisions for means of access for inspec tions (hereinafter referred to as ■the Technical provisions■) to be made mandatory under the Convention; RECOGNIZING that the Technical provisions referred to above are not inte nded to - access for inspections (hereinafter referred to as ■the Technical provisions■) to be made mandatory under the Convention; RECOGNIZING that the Technical provisions ref erred to above are not intended to inhibit the development of new or novel technol ogies which provide for an improved means to carry out ship surveys and inspections, HAVING CO NSIDERED, at its seventy-sixth session, the text of the proposed Technical provisions, 1 .

ADOPTS the Technical provisions for means of access for inspections, the text of which i s set out in the Annex to the present resolution; 2.

INVITES Contracting Governments to th e Convention to note that the Technical provisions will take effect on 1 January 2005 upon en try into force of the new regulation II-1/3-6 of the Convention; 3.

REQUESTS the Secretary-General to transmit certified copies of this resolution and the t ext of the Technical provisions contained in th e Annex to all Contracting Governments t o the Convention; 4.

FURTHER REQUESTS the Secretary-General to transmit copies of this resolution and the Ann ex to all Members of the Organization, which are not Contracting Governments to the Conv ention; - Convention; 4.

FURTHER REQUESTS the Secretary-General to transmit copies of this resolution and the Ann ex to all Members of the Organization, which are not Contracting Governments to the Conv ention; 5.

INVITES Governments to encourage the de velopment of novel technologies aimed at facilit ating the survey and inspection of ships and to keep the Organization advised of any pos itive results.

RESOLUTION MSC.133(76) (adopted on 12 December 2002) ADOPTION OF TECHNICAL PROVISIONS FO R MEANS OF ACCESS FOR INSPECTIONSMSC 76/23/Add.1 ANNEX 2 Page 2 I:\MSC\76\23-ADD.1.DOC A NNEX TECHNICAL PROVISIONS FOR MEANS OF ACCESS FOR INSPECTIONS Preamble It has long been recognised that the only way of ensuring that the condition of a ship■s structure is mai ntained to conform with the applicable requirements is for all its components to be